

Communication Skills

What is communication?

- **Communication is the process of transmitting information from one person to another.**
- **It is the act of sharing of ideas, facts, opinions, thoughts, messages or emotions to other people, in and out the organisation, with the use of the channel to create mutual understanding and confidence.**

Communication...

Communication is not tied to words, i.e. whether an individual speaks or not, the message is conveyed to the other party through other means.

Besides words, communication can take place through symbols, letters, actions, expressions, body language and gestures etc.

Communication Process

- **The Communication is a two-way process wherein the message in the form of ideas, thoughts, feelings, opinions is transmitted between two or more persons with the intent of creating a shared understanding.**
- **Simply, the process of conveying intended information and understanding from one person to another is called as communication process.**

Elements/Components of Communication

Communication is a dynamic process that begins with the conceptualizing of ideas by the sender who then transmits the message through a channel to the receiver, who in turn gives the feedback in the form of some message or signal within the given time frame.

Thus, there are seven major elements of communication process:

Elements of communication...



1. Source/Sender

The source or the sender is the person who wants to convey an idea or ideas, initiates the conversation or writing and has conceptualized the idea that he/she intends to convey it to others.

2. Encoding

- The sender begins with the encoding process wherein he uses certain words or non-verbal methods such as symbols, signs, body gestures, etc. to translate the information into a message.
- The sender's knowledge, skills, perception, background, competencies, etc. has a great impact on the success of the message.

3. Message

- **The sender wraps the idea in a definite form which is called message.**
- **The message can be written, oral, symbolic or non-verbal such as body gestures, silence, sighs, sounds, etc. or any other signal that triggers the response of a receiver.**

4. Channel

- The sender chooses the medium through which he/her wants to convey his/her message to the receiver. It must be selected carefully in order to make the message effective and correctly interpreted by the recipient.
- The choice of medium depends on the interpersonal relationships between the sender and the receiver and also on the urgency of the message being sent. Oral, virtual, written, sound, gesture, etc. are some of the commonly used communication channels.

5. Receiver

- The receiver is the person for whom the message is intended or targeted. He/she tries to comprehend it in the best possible manner such that the communication objective is attained.
- The degree to which the receiver understands the message depends on effectiveness of the sender as well as the receiver's knowledge of the subject matter, experience, trust and relationship with the sender.

6. Decoding

- **The receiver interprets the sender's message and tries to understand it in the best possible manner.**
- **An effective communication occurs only if the receiver understands the message in exactly the same way as it was intended by the sender.**

7. Feedback

- **Feedback is the final step of the process and it is the reaction or response from the receiver**
- **It ensures the receiver has received the message and interpreted it correctly or incorrectly or partial as it was intended by the sender.**
- **It increases the effectiveness of the communication as it permits the sender to know the efficacy of his message. The feedback can be verbal or non-verbal.**